



PC-ing PUT TOGETHER...

Know how to put together a PC that goes well with your budget...

We've been testing individual PC components for so long that we thought it was about time we put them all together to make a complete PC. And since anything worth doing is worth doing twice, we put together two!

Both our PCs are at budgets that left enough for a post-assembly party, and performance enough to make us proud. The All-Rounder PC would cost Rs 60,000, and the configuration is steady enough to let us play a flight simulator, while encoding a DivX movie. It should be able to briskly handle any task you throw at it, while not burning a hole in your pocket. Our 'Back to Basics' machine is an affordable Rs 20,000, perfect for surfing the Internet, working with office applications or simply watching a movie.

Digit All-Rounder PC

We had affordable performance on our minds while building the All-Rounder. We actually did go a bit overboard and splurged an extra Rs 500, but every Rupee is accounted for in the benchmarks.

Processor: AMD AthlonXP 2800+

Price: Rs 10,500

Why we chose this: Firstly, it costs a



decent Rs 11,200; secondly, it runs at 2.25 GHz and is the first to use the 333 FSB, based on the Thoroughbred core. It can run multimedia applications and play high-end games at decent resolutions. The Pentium 4 2.8 GHz is higher priced, and gives almost equivalent performance. So, this is a fair deal.

Motherboard: Gigabyte GA-7N400-L

Price: Rs 6,500

Why we chose this: This motherboard complements the processor perfectly, and features the latest nVidia nForce 2 Ultra 400 chipset with DDR 400 SDRAM support, and also ATA-133 hard drives. So, if you plug in a DDR 400 RAM module and use a 7200-rpm Ultra-ATA hard drive, your system is bound to give you peak performance. This means that the ultra-real-